

Forked tongue tastes and smells the outside world

Single parent

This female aphid is giving birth, without having mated first. This way of breeding is quite common in insects. In spring, when food is plentiful, some female aphids can produce up to 10 young a day. Each one is a tiny copy, or clone, of the mother. Male and female aphids also mate later in the year to produce eggs, which can survive through the winter months.



Once the shell has been torn open, the snake may stay inside its egg for several more hours

Finally, the tiny rat snake slides out of the egg, leaving its crumpled shell behind

Hungry hatchling

Even when they are tiny, caterpillars have strong jaws. This owl butterfly caterpillar has just chewed its way out of its egg and is setting off in search of food. Many caterpillars eat their shells after hatching. The shells are rich in protein, so they make a nutritious first meal.



Giving birth

Watched anxiously by its mother, a young guanaco makes its entrance into the world. Some mammals—including guanacos—give birth to young that can walk and run within a few hours. At the other extreme, newly born pouched mammals, or marsupials—such as kangaroos—are tiny, hairless, and blind. To survive, they must continue growing inside their mother's pouch.